

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Real Estate English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For real estate agents, brokers, transaction coordinators, property managers, leasing teams, and commercial real estate staff.

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Agency, Representation, Compensation, and Trust

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

02 Client Intake, Needs Analysis, and Property Search

Clarify missing information before responding.

03 Listings, Property Descriptions, Pricing, and Market Data

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

04 Showings, Open Houses, Fair Housing, and Advertising

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

05 Offers, Counteroffers, Negotiation, and Contingencies

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

06 Inspections, Repairs, Disclosures, and Due Diligence

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

07 Financing, Appraisal, Title, Escrow, and Closing

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

08 Leasing, Property Management, Commercial Basics, Ethics, and Crisis Scenarios

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Agency, Representation, Compensation, and Trust

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A prospective buyer asks whether an agent represents both sides. The relationship has not yet been established or documented.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Agency disclosure - Required explanation or document identifying the professional's role and who is represented.

Fiduciary duty - Duties such as loyalty, confidentiality, disclosure, obedience, reasonable care, and accounting, depending on law and role.

Buyer representation agreement - Agreement defining buyer services, term, compensation, exclusivity, and other obligations.

Designated agency - Same brokerage but different designated agents represent different clients, where permitted.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
 - B. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
 - C. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?
 - B. How would you describe the next step in your own words?
 - C. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A conversation does not establish representation

The lesson's prospective buyer asks whether the agent represents both sides; the relationship is not established or documented. This is language practice, not legal advice.

01 • Prospective buyer: Do you represent both me and the seller because we're discussing this property together?

02 • Real estate agent: The relationship hasn't been established or documented. This conversation alone doesn't answer whom I represent.

03 • Prospective buyer: Then what is the difference between explaining a property and agreeing to represent me?

04 • Real estate agent: Property information describes the listing; representation involves an arrangement whose scope needs to be clarified.

05 • Prospective buyer: Would an agency disclosure and a buyer representation agreement serve exactly the same purpose?

06 • Real estate agent: We should review the applicable documents rather than treat their different functions as interchangeable.

07 • Prospective buyer: I also want to understand compensation before assuming any obligation exists.

08 • Real estate agent: That's appropriate. We'll explain the proposed relationship and terms using the actual documents and relevant review.

09 • Prospective buyer: Please don't describe me as already represented while that discussion remains unfinished.

10 • Real estate agent: Agreed. We'll clarify the relationship before making claims about duties, authority, or compensation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A team name does not identify the representative

Separate fictional brokerage exercise: two agents use the same team branding; a buyer asks whether that establishes designated agency. No arrangement is supplied.

01 • Buyer: Both agents use the same team name. Does that mean you have designated agency here?

02 • Broker: Team branding doesn't establish the representation arrangement. We need the actual documents and applicable context.

03 • Buyer: So the team's marketing identity and an agent's role in the transaction are different questions?

04 • Broker: Exactly. We shouldn't infer duties or authority from the logo on a business card.

05 • Buyer: Could you explain who is proposed to represent whom before I discuss negotiating instructions?

06 • Broker: Yes. I'll identify the proposed roles and refer any unresolved legal questions for appropriate review.

07 • Buyer: Would mentioning fiduciary duty settle every detail of that relationship for me?

08 • Broker: No. A general term doesn't replace an explanation of the actual arrangement and relevant obligations.

09 • Buyer: Then let's review the representation information before treating the team as acting for me.

10 • Broker: Agreed. We'll keep any unestablished role or compensation term explicit during that review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An introduction is not an engagement

Separate fictional referral: a relocation coordinator introduces a buyer to an agent; no buyer representation agreement or compensation terms have been discussed.

01 • Relocation coordinator: I introduced the buyer to you. May I tell them representation is now arranged?

02 • Real estate agent: No. An introduction connects us; it doesn't establish the representation or compensation terms.

03 • Relocation coordinator: The buyer wants someone to negotiate for them, not merely send property information.

04 • Real estate agent: Then we need to discuss that proposed role and the relevant agreement before assuming authority.

05 • Relocation coordinator: Would you explain that distinction directly so my introduction doesn't create a false expectation?

06 • Real estate agent: Yes. I'll say we're discussing a possible engagement, not that a documented relationship already exists.

07 • Relocation coordinator: Should I quote a standard compensation amount to make the introduction more helpful?

08 • Real estate agent: Don't invent one. The actual proposed terms need to be provided and reviewed.

09 • Relocation coordinator: I'll correct my description to an introduction for a representation discussion.

10 • Real estate agent: Thank you. That keeps the buyer informed without creating obligations from an assumed arrangement.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Agency, Representation, Compensation, and Trust

A prospective buyer asks whether an agent represents both sides. The relationship has not yet been established or documented.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: Before we discuss a property, let's clarify who would represent whom and review the required disclosures and agreements. The available arrangements depend on the applicable rules and the parties' agreement.

Scenario 2 | A showing appointment and negotiating authority

A fictional agent has agreed to show a property, but representation and authority to negotiate have not been established. The visitor asks the agent to tell the seller an offer is certain.

Role A: You are the agent. Explain the limited confirmed appointment and clarify the unestablished negotiating role.

Role B: You are the prospective buyer. Ask what discussion is needed before any offer communication.

Possible opening: The showing is arranged, but we haven't established representation or instructions to communicate an offer.

Success checks

- Distinguish the appointment from representation.
- Avoid implying an offer or authority already exists.
- Agree to clarify roles and instructions before negotiation.

Add a complication: The visitor says booking a showing should count as permission to negotiate.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Client Intake, Needs Analysis, and Property Search

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A buyer asks for a "good neighborhood" and "a short commute." They have not specified transport, budget, or property needs.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Client - A person represented by the real estate professional under an agency or representation relationship.

Customer - A person receiving limited services or information but not represented as a client, depending on state law.

Pre-approval - Lender review indicating likely borrowing capacity, subject to underwriting and property review.

Proof of funds - Documentation showing funds available for cash purchase or down payment.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - B. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - C. Could you confirm when does the review start?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - B. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - C. Who will present the report at the meeting?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Making neighborhood preferences concrete

Separate fictional extension of the lesson: a buyer wants to travel by train to Central Station in no more than thirty minutes door to door. Budget, other property needs, pre-approval, and proof of funds remain unknown.

01 • Buyer: I'd like a good neighborhood and a short commute. Can you help make those preferences more precise?

02 • Real estate agent: Certainly. What is your destination, preferred transport, and maximum door-to-door travel time?

03 • Buyer: Central Station, by train, with no more than thirty minutes from my door to the station.

04 • Real estate agent: So your search preference is Central Station by train within thirty minutes door to door, including walking and waiting?

05 • Buyer: Yes. A thirty-minute train journey plus extra walking would not meet that preference.

06 • Real estate agent: Understood. We'll check actual routes rather than infer travel time from distance or neighborhood descriptions.

07 • Buyer: I still haven't specified my budget or other property needs. Can we discuss those next?

08 • Real estate agent: Yes. Have you supplied pre-approval or proof of funds for us to review?

09 • Buyer: Neither yet. Please keep financing unconfirmed rather than assume the commute preference establishes what I can afford.

10 • Real estate agent: Agreed. We have a concrete travel criterion, with budget, property needs, and financing still to clarify.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Accessible means more than a vague listing label

Separate fictional property search: a buyer wants step-free entry but has not specified other access requirements; listing verification is pending.

01 • Buyer: I need step-free entry. Could we filter the search for properties described as accessible?

02 • Search agent: We can investigate, but could you clarify which specific access features matter beyond the entrance?

03 • Buyer: I haven't listed the other requirements. The step-free entrance is the one confirmed need.

04 • Search agent: Then we shouldn't assume a broad listing label establishes that every space meets your needs.

05 • Buyer: Could you ask about the actual entrance arrangement before recommending a viewing?

06 • Search agent: Yes. I'll request property-specific information and keep any unverified feature clearly marked.

07 • Buyer: Does a photograph of the front door establish there are no steps elsewhere on the route?

08 • Search agent: Not necessarily. We need to check the route rather than infer it from one image.

09 • Buyer: I'll describe any additional requirements separately without being asked to justify personal details.

10 • Search agent: Good. We'll focus on concrete features and verified information when narrowing the search.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Pre-approval and proof of funds answer different questions

Separate fictional intake: a buyer mentions a lender conversation but supplies neither a pre-approval document nor proof of funds.

01 • Buying agent: You mentioned speaking to a lender. What documentation, if any, has the lender actually provided?

02 • Buyer: I haven't supplied a document. I thought the conversation itself meant everything was financially confirmed.

03 • Buying agent: Let's keep the status unconfirmed until we know what was issued and what it states.

04 • Buyer: Is proof of funds simply another name for pre-approval in the search process?

05 • Buying agent: They address different evidence: available funds and a lender's assessment are not interchangeable.

06 • Buyer: Then what should I ask the lender before we rely on a financing statement?

07 • Buying agent: Ask what document exists, its scope, and any conditions; the lender should explain its meaning.

08 • Buyer: I'll obtain that clarification through the appropriate channel rather than claim final financing approval.

09 • Buying agent: Good. We can discuss property needs while keeping the financing information accurately qualified.

10 • Buyer: Please note that no reviewed financing document or proof of funds is available yet.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Client Intake, Needs Analysis, and Property Search

A buyer asks for a "good neighborhood" and "a short commute." They have not specified transport, budget, or property needs.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: What commute time and transport options would work for you? Let's also list your budget and property requirements so we can use clear, relevant criteria for the search.

Scenario 2 | Near the station needs a route definition

A fictional buyer wants a property near a station. They have not specified walking time, preferred route, or whether transfers matter. No properties have been assessed.

Role A: You are the search agent. Ask for measurable travel preferences without assuming household or neighborhood characteristics.

Role B: You are the buyer. Clarify how you would evaluate proximity and which details remain undecided.

Possible opening: When you say near the station, what walking time and route would you consider suitable?

Success checks

- Clarify the travel measure.
- Separate map distance from an actual route assessment.
- Agree a search criterion while preserving undecided preferences.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests using a straight-line map distance as if it were verified walking time.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Listings, Property Descriptions, Pricing, and Market Data

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A pricing presentation uses three recent sales, but one property is much larger and another required major repairs.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

CMA - Comparative market analysis using comparable properties and market data to support pricing.

Comp - Comparable property used to estimate likely market value.

List price - Price at which the property is offered to the market.

Sale price - Final contract or closed price, depending on context.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - B. The change must have caused the delay.
 - C. The change definitely caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...
 - B. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - C. In this pilot, the observed result was ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Three sales do not make three equal comparisons

The lesson's pricing presentation uses three recent sales; one is much larger and another required major repairs.

01 • Seller: The three recent sales look persuasive. Can we average them and call that our property's value?

02 • Listing agent: We need to account for differences. One comp is much larger, and another required major repairs.

03 • Seller: So a recent sale isn't automatically a closely comparable property for the CMA?

04 • Listing agent: Correct. A comparative market analysis needs context, not just a list of nearby prices.

05 • Seller: Have the size and condition differences already been assessed in the presentation?

06 • Listing agent: That assessment isn't supplied here. We shouldn't invent adjustment amounts to make the comparison complete.

07 • Seller: Then a proposed list price would still be a judgment, not a guaranteed sale price.

08 • Listing agent: Exactly. The observed sales inform the discussion without determining this property's final outcome.

09 • Seller: Please show the differences and identify the analysis still needed before recommending a figure.

10 • Listing agent: I will. The presentation should make the evidence useful without overstating comparability or certainty.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Asking prices are not completed sales

Separate fictional pricing exercise: a seller brings three active listing prices, but no sale prices or transaction outcomes are supplied.

01 • Seller: These three listings have high prices. Doesn't that prove buyers are paying those amounts?

02 • Listing agent: They show asking prices, not completed sale prices. We don't have the transaction outcomes.

03 • Seller: Could we still include them in the market discussion without calling them sold comps?

04 • Listing agent: Yes. Active listings may describe competition, but their role differs from evidence of completed sales.

05 • Seller: I was going to say the market has already validated that price level.

06 • Listing agent: That would exceed the evidence. A list price is an offer to the market, not proof of acceptance.

07 • Seller: Then let's identify which figures are listings and seek appropriate completed-sale information separately.

08 • Listing agent: Good. We'll also examine property differences rather than assume equal value from the area alone.

09 • Seller: The pricing recommendation should remain provisional until that comparison is properly assessed.

10 • Listing agent: Agreed. We'll distinguish available observations from the judgment still being developed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A renovated label needs supporting detail

Separate fictional listing review: a draft calls a property fully renovated, but the supplied record confirms only replacement kitchen cabinets.

01 • Listing coordinator: The description says fully renovated, but the record only confirms replacement kitchen cabinets.

02 • Listing agent: Then the broad condition claim isn't supported by the facts currently supplied.

03 • Listing coordinator: Could the new cabinets justify assuming the electrical and plumbing systems were updated too?

04 • Listing agent: No. Those are separate features, and their status hasn't been established here.

05 • Listing coordinator: I'll propose a precise statement about the cabinets and leave other work unconfirmed.

06 • Listing agent: Good. We should request supporting information before expanding the property description.

07 • Listing coordinator: Does a more attractive description allow a stronger list-price conclusion in the CMA?

08 • Listing agent: Only evidence about the property and market can support that analysis, not promotional wording itself.

09 • Listing coordinator: I'll keep description accuracy separate from the pricing judgment and note the missing renovation detail.

10 • Listing agent: That will prevent an unsupported condition claim from spreading into the market presentation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Listings, Property Descriptions, Pricing, and Market Data

A pricing presentation uses three recent sales, but one property is much larger and another required major repairs.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: These sales provide context, but they are not identical to the property. I'll explain the differences in size and condition and how they limit the comparison instead of presenting one certain sale price.

Scenario 2 | A sale outside the stated period

A fictional CMA labels all comparisons as sales from the last three months, but one included transaction occurred a year ago. No market-time adjustment has been assessed.

Role A: You review the CMA. Identify the date mismatch and limit the comparison claim.

Role B: You prepared the analysis. Explain whether to relabel, investigate, or replace the older sale without inventing an adjustment.

Possible opening: One sale is a year old, so the current last-three-months description isn't accurate.

Success checks

- State the older sale's actual period.
- Avoid inventing a market adjustment.
- Agree a transparent revision or further comparison review.

Add a complication: A stakeholder asks you to change the date label without disclosing the older transaction.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Showings, Open Houses, Fair Housing, and Advertising

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A listing draft uses vague claims about the "ideal type of family." The team needs a description focused on the property.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Protected class - A legally protected characteristic under federal, state, or local fair housing laws.

Steering - Directing people toward or away from housing based on protected-class characteristics.

Material fact - Fact that could affect a party's decision or property value, subject to applicable law.

Reasonable accommodation - Change in rules or services that may be needed for a person with a disability.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
 - B. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
 - C. Send it no later than Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?
 - B. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - C. Could you confirm that the review is important?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Requesting a property-focused description

The lesson's listing draft describes an ideal type of family rather than the property; specific replacement features have not been supplied.

01 • Broker: Could you revise the listing so it describes the property rather than an ideal type of family?

02 • Listing writer: What kind of replacement would preserve useful information without guessing who should live there?

03 • Broker: Use verified property features, and request missing details instead of substituting assumptions about prospective occupants.

04 • Listing writer: Should I invent a spacious-garden claim because that sounds less personal?

05 • Broker: No. We haven't established that feature. Property-focused wording still needs factual support.

06 • Listing writer: I'll ask for confirmed layout and amenity details before proposing the revised description.

07 • Broker: Good. Our review should also consider the applicable advertising requirements without relying on stereotypes or steering.

08 • Listing writer: Can you confirm the review route before we schedule publication of the revision?

09 • Broker: I'll arrange that check. I can't call the revised advertisement approved before it's assessed.

10 • Listing writer: Then I'll provide a factual draft for review, with any missing material fact identified.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A showing request needs a route check

Separate fictional showing: a visitor requests a step-free route; the agent has not verified access to the property entrance.

01 • Showing agent: Could you confirm whether there is a step-free route to the entrance before I finalize this showing?

02 • Property coordinator: I haven't checked the route. Is the visitor asking us to assume the building is fully accessible?

03 • Showing agent: No. The request concerns the entrance route, and we should clarify that specific feature.

04 • Property coordinator: I'll ask the responsible property contact rather than infer access from the front photograph.

05 • Showing agent: Please confirm a realistic time for the check, since the appointment shouldn't imply verified access.

06 • Property coordinator: Would a reasonable-accommodation question require a separate review if the existing route doesn't meet the request?

07 • Showing agent: We should route that appropriately under the actual circumstances, not invent a universal rule here.

08 • Property coordinator: I'll return the verified route information and identify anything that still needs assessment.

09 • Showing agent: Thank you. I'll keep the visitor updated without promising a feature that hasn't been checked.

10 • Property coordinator: The next action is the route check, with appointment details to be confirmed afterward.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Rejecting a request to screen by imagined residents

Separate fictional open-house planning: a seller asks the agent to invite only people who seem like the current neighbors; no legitimate property-related criterion is given.

01 • Seller: Could you invite only buyers who seem like the current neighbors to the open house?

02 • Listing agent: Please focus any request on the property and the showing arrangements, not assumptions about who belongs here.

03 • Seller: I meant people who would fit in. Can you turn that into a screening description?

04 • Listing agent: I can't use that vague idea to sort visitors by personal characteristics or implied protected-class preferences.

05 • Seller: Then what information can we usefully confirm before the event?

06 • Listing agent: The actual viewing arrangements and verified property details, with any advertising concern referred for review.

07 • Seller: Could you request those details from the property coordinator and leave resident descriptions out?

08 • Listing agent: Yes. I'll keep the invitation property-focused and avoid steering people based on an imagined community fit.

09 • Seller: I understand. My request should concern the event, not the type of person who attends.

10 • Listing agent: Good. We'll review the factual invitation through the proper process before it is distributed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Showings, Open Houses, Fair Housing, and Advertising

A listing draft uses vague claims about the "ideal type of family." The team needs a description focused on the property.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Please describe the rooms, features, and location facts instead. We can make the listing informative by stating what the property offers and sending the wording through our advertising review.

Scenario 2 | A school claim without a source

A fictional listing draft says guaranteed admission to a named school. No admission evidence is supplied, and the advertisement is unpublished.

Role A: You are the broker. Request removal of the unsupported guarantee and a source check for any factual location statement.

Role B: You are the listing coordinator. Offer a reviewable correction without replacing it with another unverified claim.

Possible opening: Could you remove the admission guarantee and check what school-related information we can actually substantiate?

Success checks

- Reject repetition as evidence of admission rights.
- Keep the unpublished status clear.
- Request verified information and appropriate advertising review.

Add a complication: The seller says nearby properties use the same claim, so it must be safe to repeat.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Offers, Counteroffers, Negotiation, and Contingencies

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

SITUATION

A proposed offer requests completion in 30 days. The buyer's financing timeline is still provisional.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Earnest money - Deposit showing buyer seriousness, handled according to contract and escrow rules.

Contingency - Contract condition that must be satisfied or waived for the transaction to continue.

Appraisal gap - Difference between contract price and appraised value that can create financing or negotiation issues.

Backup offer - Offer accepted or held in position if the primary contract fails, depending on local practice.

3. Notice the language

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Compare this wording: If you will approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Offer a workable tradeoff

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence presents a normal future condition clearly?
 - A. If the scope changes, we reviewed the schedule.
 - B. If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.
 - C. If the scope will change, we will review the schedule.
2. Which response negotiates a new request without silently promising extra work?
 - A. We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.
 - B. We have included it, although its scope has not been reviewed.
 - C. We guarantee the original date without assessing the addition.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Thirty days remains a proposed completion date

The lesson's proposed offer seeks completion in thirty days, but the buyer's financing timeline is provisional.

01 • Buyer: I'd like completion in thirty days. Can we promise the seller that date?

02 • Buying agent: Your financing timeline is still provisional, so we cannot present that date as guaranteed.

03 • Buyer: Could a financing contingency make the timing certain regardless of when the lender finishes?

04 • Buying agent: We shouldn't assume that. Any proposed contingency and its implications need appropriate review.

05 • Buyer: What choices can we discuss now without presenting the financing as already settled?

06 • Buying agent: We can present thirty days as requested, with financing uncertainty explicit, or wait for the lender's timeline before proposing timing.

07 • Buyer: I'll choose to wait for the lender's timeline. Please don't communicate a firm completion commitment yet.

08 • Buying agent: Understood. Waiting gives us more timing information but delays presenting that part of the proposal.

09 • Buyer: I accept that tradeoff. I'll request the lender's estimate, without treating it as the seller's agreement.

10 • Buying agent: Then we'll review the timing and terms together. No completion date or seller acceptance is confirmed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An appraisal gap is not an unlimited instruction

Separate fictional offer exercise: a buyer is willing to discuss an appraisal-gap provision but has given no amount or final instruction.

01 • Buying agent: You said you would discuss an appraisal-gap provision. What limit, if any, are you considering?

02 • Buyer: I haven't decided an amount. I didn't mean I would cover any possible difference.

03 • Buying agent: Then we should keep the discussion separate from an offer instruction or financial commitment.

04 • Buyer: Could we compare a capped proposal with leaving the issue for further negotiation?

05 • Buying agent: We can discuss those options, subject to your circumstances and review of the actual wording.

06 • Buyer: Would a proposed cap automatically tell us how the lender will respond?

07 • Buying agent: No. Financing implications need lender clarification; we shouldn't infer them from a conversational example.

08 • Buyer: Please request that clarification before presenting any figure on my behalf.

09 • Buying agent: I will. Your willingness to explore a term isn't authorization to submit an unlimited commitment.

10 • Buyer: Good. Let's agree the limit and review the conditions before changing the offer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A backup offer does not replace the first agreement automatically

Separate fictional negotiation: a buyer wants to discuss a backup offer while another transaction is pending; no backup terms or acceptance are supplied.

01 • Buyer: If we make a backup offer, can we assume the property will become ours if the first buyer hesitates?

02 • Buying agent: No. We need to understand the actual status and review any proposed backup terms.

03 • Buyer: Then being a backup doesn't mean we control when the existing transaction ends.

04 • Buying agent: Correct. We shouldn't promise availability or invent how a condition operates without the relevant documents.

05 • Buyer: Could we ask about the process while keeping our own commitment undecided?

06 • Buying agent: Yes. I'll request the appropriate information and bring any proposed terms for your review.

07 • Buyer: I also want to compare the effect on pursuing other properties before giving instructions.

08 • Buying agent: That is a question for review, not something to resolve with a universal assurance.

09 • Buyer: Then our next step is an information request, not a submitted offer.

10 • Buying agent: Agreed. I'll preserve that boundary and avoid describing a backup position as secured.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Offers, Counteroffers, Negotiation, and Contingencies

A proposed offer requests completion in 30 days. The buyer's financing timeline is still provisional.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Second round: The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Model for scenario 1: The buyer prefers 30 days, but the financing timeline is not confirmed. Could we discuss the proposed timing and any relevant contingencies with the appropriate parties before making a firm commitment?

Scenario 2 | A possession request beyond the proposed closing

A fictional seller asks to remain in the property for two weeks after the proposed closing. The buyer has not agreed, and costs, responsibilities, and lender implications are unreviewed.

Role A: You represent the buyer in the discussion. Separate the requested possession timing from the closing date.

Role B: You coordinate the seller's proposal. Ask what terms need review before the request can be considered.

Possible opening: The two-week possession request is separate from the proposed closing date, and its conditions are not agreed.

Success checks

- Name the two-week request accurately.
- Keep costs, responsibilities, and relevant review unresolved.
- Offer a reviewable proposal without promising acceptance.

Add a complication: The seller wants verbal reassurance that the arrangement is approved immediately.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Inspections, Repairs, Disclosures, and Due Diligence

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

An inspection report identifies an issue and recommends specialist evaluation. A buyer asks the agent to diagnose it.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Inspection period - Time allowed for property inspection and related negotiations.

Material fact - Fact that could affect a party's decision or property value, subject to applicable law.

Lead-based paint disclosure - Federal disclosure requirements for many pre-1978 residential properties.

Concession - Seller or landlord contribution to buyer or tenant costs, repairs, or other terms.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - B. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
 - C. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - B. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?
 - C. How would you describe the next step in your own words?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An inspection observation is not the agent's diagnosis

The lesson's inspection report identifies an issue and recommends specialist evaluation; its cause and repair scope are not supplied.

01 • Buyer: The inspection report flags an issue. Can you tell me exactly what's causing it?

02 • Real estate agent: The report recommends specialist evaluation. I can explain that next step, but not diagnose the issue.

03 • Buyer: So the observed issue and the cause are different levels of information here.

04 • Real estate agent: Exactly. We shouldn't turn a recommendation for evaluation into a confirmed repair diagnosis.

05 • Buyer: Could you estimate the concession we should request before the specialist checks it?

06 • Real estate agent: No repair scope or cost is supplied. We need relevant information before discussing a supported proposal.

07 • Buyer: Does the inspection period tell us which timing questions we should ask the transaction team?

08 • Real estate agent: Yes, using the actual agreement and appropriate review, not a deadline invented in this conversation.

09 • Buyer: Please help arrange the specialist inquiry and keep the cause unresolved in our discussion.

10 • Real estate agent: I will. We'll distinguish the report's observation, evaluation recommendation, and any later findings.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A credit is not evidence of completed repair

Separate fictional due-diligence conversation: the seller proposes a repair credit, but no repair completion evidence is supplied.

01 • Buyer: The seller offered a credit. Does that mean the defect will be repaired before we proceed?

02 • Buying agent: A proposed financial concession isn't evidence that repair work has been completed or even agreed.

03 • Buyer: Then the credit proposal and the physical condition need to be discussed separately.

04 • Buying agent: Correct. We need the actual terms and any specialist information about the work.

05 • Buyer: Could the amount itself prove the repair will be adequate?

06 • Buying agent: No. A number doesn't establish scope, quality, or completion, and we don't have those findings.

07 • Buyer: I'd like to understand the issue before treating the concession as a full solution.

08 • Buying agent: I'll request the relevant information and arrange review of the proposal's conditions.

09 • Buyer: Please don't tell the transaction team that the repair concern is resolved yet.

10 • Buying agent: Agreed. The current status is a proposed concession with the underlying assessment still open.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A disclosure form is not a test result

Separate fictional property review: a file contains a lead-based paint disclosure document, but no test result is supplied. Applicable requirements are not being determined in this exercise.

01 • Buyer: The file includes a lead-based paint disclosure. Does that prove the property tested clear?

02 • Transaction agent: No test result is supplied here. A disclosure document and a testing result are different records.

03 • Buyer: So I shouldn't interpret the document's title as a finding about the property's condition.

04 • Transaction agent: Correct. We should examine what the document actually states and identify any missing assessment.

05 • Buyer: Can you tell me what inspection or legal requirement applies from this short description alone?

06 • Transaction agent: No. Those questions need the actual property facts, relevant documents, and qualified current review.

07 • Buyer: Please help me ask the appropriate professional what information is available and what remains unknown.

08 • Transaction agent: I will, without describing the absence of a supplied result as either safety confirmation or confirmed contamination.

09 • Buyer: That distinction helps me understand the paperwork without assuming a diagnosis.

10 • Transaction agent: Good. We'll keep the document, any testing evidence, and applicable requirements separate during review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Inspections, Repairs, Disclosures, and Due Diligence

An inspection report identifies an issue and recommends specialist evaluation. A buyer asks the agent to diagnose it.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: The report identifies a concern but does not establish its full cause or repair cost. We can help arrange the recommended specialist review so you have better information for your decision.

Scenario 2 | A stain and an unverified repair story

A fictional buyer sees a ceiling stain. The seller says an earlier leak was repaired, but no repair documentation or specialist assessment is supplied.

Role A: You are the agent. Distinguish the visible stain from the seller's account and any diagnosis.

Role B: You are the buyer. Ask what evidence or specialist review would help clarify the issue.

Possible opening: We can observe the stain and attribute the seller's repair statement, but the underlying condition is not verified.

Success checks

- Separate observation, reported history, and unverified cause.
- Avoid diagnosing or guaranteeing condition.
- Agree a documentation or specialist inquiry with transaction timing reviewed separately.

Add a complication: Someone asks you to assure the buyer that the stain is purely cosmetic.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Financing, Appraisal, Title, Escrow, and Closing

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

A transaction checklist shows the appraisal received but title questions still open. A client asks whether everything is ready to close.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Loan Estimate - Mortgage disclosure showing estimated loan terms, payments, closing costs, and cash to close.

Closing Disclosure - Mortgage disclosure showing final or near-final loan terms, costs, and cash to close.

Title search - Review of public records to confirm ownership and identify liens, easements, or other issues.

Escrow - Neutral holding and coordination of funds, documents, or closing conditions, depending on state practice.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team is completing the review.
 - B. The team plans to complete the review.
 - C. The team has completed the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
 - B. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.
 - C. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Appraisal received, title questions still open

The lesson's checklist shows the appraisal received and title questions unresolved; overall closing readiness is not established.

01 • Buyer: The appraisal has arrived. Does that mean everything is ready for closing now?

02 • Transaction coordinator: Not yet. The checklist still shows open title questions, so overall readiness isn't confirmed.

03 • Buyer: Then receiving one document is a completed step, not completion of the whole transaction.

04 • Transaction coordinator: Exactly. We should distinguish appraisal receipt from unresolved title work and any other required confirmations.

05 • Buyer: Could the title search be called clear simply because we haven't received another warning?

06 • Transaction coordinator: No. The open questions need an actual status response, not an inference from silence.

07 • Buyer: Please ask the title professional what remains and how it affects the closing discussion.

08 • Transaction coordinator: I will. I won't promise a date or legal outcome that hasn't been confirmed.

09 • Buyer: And any escrow or lender status should remain separate from the appraisal receipt.

10 • Transaction coordinator: Agreed. I'll give you a verified progress update with completed and pending items clearly identified.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Receiving a closing document is not approval of every figure

Separate fictional transaction exercise: a buyer received a Closing Disclosure but has not discussed a questioned fee with the lender.

01 • Buyer: I received the Closing Disclosure, but one fee differs from what I expected.

02 • Transaction coordinator: Then receipt is confirmed, while your question about that figure still needs lender clarification.

03 • Buyer: Can you mark the financing paperwork complete so the checklist looks ready?

04 • Transaction coordinator: Not on that basis. We should keep the unresolved fee question visible rather than imply it's settled.

05 • Buyer: Should I compare it with the Loan Estimate and ask the lender to explain the difference?

06 • Transaction coordinator: That is a useful document question for the lender, without assuming the difference is an error.

07 • Buyer: We haven't established why it changed, so I won't call it an unauthorized charge.

08 • Transaction coordinator: Correct. I'll record the inquiry and ask who will provide the explanation.

09 • Buyer: Please distinguish the document received from the review and closing confirmations still pending.

10 • Transaction coordinator: I will. The status update won't treat possession of paperwork as resolution of every issue.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Wire instructions awaiting independent confirmation

Separate fictional closing exercise: a buyer receives an unexpected message with changed payment instructions; authenticity is unverified and no payment has been sent.

01 • Buyer: I received changed payment instructions unexpectedly. Is this the final escrow step I should complete?

02 • Closing coordinator: Authenticity is unverified. Don't treat the message itself as confirmed instructions or a completed funds check.

03 • Buyer: No payment has been sent. What status should be recorded while we verify it?

04 • Closing coordinator: Unexpected instructions received, verification pending, and no payment sent. Keep those facts separate.

05 • Buyer: Should I use the new message's contact details to establish that it's genuine?

06 • Closing coordinator: Use an independently established trusted contact route with the responsible closing professional for verification.

07 • Buyer: Then we aren't declaring fraud, but we also aren't assuming the instructions are valid.

08 • Closing coordinator: Exactly. The appropriate review needs to establish authenticity before any payment decision.

09 • Buyer: I'll request that check and leave the funds-transfer task incomplete for now.

10 • Closing coordinator: I'll coordinate the verified status response without promising that the message is genuine or the closing ready.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Financing, Appraisal, Title, Escrow, and Closing

A transaction checklist shows the appraisal received but title questions still open. A client asks whether everything is ready to close.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The appraisal has been received. Title questions remain open, so I cannot say that every closing item is complete. I'll confirm the outstanding items and the next update with the responsible professionals.

Scenario 2 | Signing reported; receipt unconfirmed

A fictional seller says they signed a requested document, but the transaction team's receipt record has not been checked. No one has confirmed acceptance or completeness.

Role A: You coordinate the transaction. Separate reported signing, confirmed receipt, and review.

Role B: You represent the seller. Ask which status check is needed before calling the task complete.

Possible opening: Signing is reported, but receipt and review have not yet been confirmed.

Success checks

- Attribute the reported signing.
- Keep receipt and acceptance unconfirmed.
- Agree the recipient-status check without inventing overall closing readiness.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to mark the entire closing package complete on the seller's statement alone.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Leasing, Property Management, Commercial Basics, Ethics, and Crisis Scenarios

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

SITUATION

A tenant has reported a leak twice and received no update. The property team has logged the issue but has no confirmed appointment.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Lease term - Length and conditions of a lease agreement.

Security deposit - Funds held to cover certain tenant obligations, subject to state and local rules.

Rent roll - Schedule of rents, tenants, lease dates, and payment status for a property.

NOI - Net operating income; property income after operating expenses but before debt service and some other items.

3. Notice the language

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Compare this wording: I'm sorry if you failed to understand.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Repair a misunderstanding

4. Check the language

1. Which apology takes responsibility for unclear wording?
 - A. I'm sorry we could not meet the original date.
 - B. I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.
 - C. I'm sorry the process took longer than expected.
2. What should follow an apology for an incorrect date?
 - A. The corrected date and the current confirmation status.
 - B. A longer explanation that never states the correct date.
 - C. A new guaranteed date even if it is unverified.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two leak reports without an appointment update

The lesson's tenant reported a leak twice. The issue is logged, but no appointment is confirmed; urgency has not been assessed here.

01 • Tenant: I've reported the leak twice and still haven't received an appointment update.

02 • Property manager: You're right. We logged the issue, but we haven't provided a confirmed appointment or a clear status.

03 • Tenant: Does logged mean a contractor is already scheduled to attend the property?

04 • Property manager: No. That distinction was unclear, and I shouldn't imply a booking that hasn't been confirmed.

05 • Tenant: Please correct the message and tell me what actually happens next.

06 • Property manager: I'll request prompt triage through the property's maintenance process and seek a confirmed appointment update.

07 • Tenant: Can you guarantee the visit time or tell me the leak is harmless now?

08 • Property manager: No. Neither is established. Any immediate hazard needs the appropriate urgent response, not an unsupported reassurance.

09 • Tenant: I want the maintenance concern addressed separately from any lease-term or deposit discussion.

10 • Property manager: Understood. I'll keep the report open and communicate verified status rather than describe logging as resolution.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A security-deposit inquiry mislabeled closed

Separate fictional management record: a former tenant asked for a deposit-accounting explanation; an acknowledgment was sent, but the explanation is pending.

01 • Former tenant: The portal marks my security-deposit inquiry closed, but I received only an acknowledgment.

02 • Property manager: That status is inaccurate. Receipt was acknowledged, while the requested accounting explanation remains pending.

03 • Former tenant: Then closing the inquiry doesn't mean the amounts have actually been reviewed with me.

04 • Property manager: Correct. I'll request a status correction and route the substantive question to the responsible reviewer.

05 • Former tenant: Can you tell me today that every deduction is valid or promise a specific refund?

06 • Property manager: Not from this record. The relevant documentation and applicable requirements need review.

07 • Former tenant: Please don't treat this call as acceptance of figures I haven't had explained.

08 • Property manager: I won't. I'll document your unanswered question and distinguish communication repair from the accounting outcome.

09 • Former tenant: Let me know the next confirmed step without inventing a legal deadline.

10 • Property manager: Agreed. We'll provide an accurate process update and keep the underlying inquiry unresolved until addressed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A rent-roll figure was called operating income

Separate fictional commercial report: a manager labeled scheduled rent from a rent roll as NOI; operating expenses have not been included.

01 • Property owner: You called the rent-roll total net operating income. Does that figure include operating expenses?

02 • Asset manager: No. I mislabeled scheduled rent as NOI, and I need to correct the report.

03 • Property owner: So the rent roll describes rental information, whereas the income measure needs a different calculation.

04 • Asset manager: Exactly. We haven't included the relevant operating expenses, and scheduled rent isn't automatically collected cash.

05 • Property owner: Could you simply subtract an assumed expense percentage to make the correction complete?

06 • Asset manager: That would invent inputs. I'll obtain the actual basis needed and keep the NOI calculation pending.

07 • Property owner: Please retain the useful rent-roll information while removing the unsupported income claim.

08 • Asset manager: I will. The correction will identify the original label error and the missing calculation inputs.

09 • Property owner: Then we can discuss property performance after the figures are properly reconciled.

10 • Asset manager: Agreed. I won't replace one misleading label with an unverified profitability estimate.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Leasing, Property Management, Commercial Basics, Ethics, and Crisis Scenarios

A tenant has reported a leak twice and received no update. The property team has logged the issue but has no confirmed appointment.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Second round: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for scenario 1: I'm sorry you have had to follow up. The issue is logged, but I do not yet have a confirmed appointment. I'll contact the responsible team and update you today, even if the timing is still pending.

Scenario 2 | A lease-renewal inquiry mistaken for agreement

A fictional tenant asked what renewal options exist. The management record says renewal accepted, although no acceptance or new lease term is documented.

Role A: You are the property manager. Acknowledge the inaccurate record and distinguish inquiry from agreement.

Role B: You are the tenant. Ask for the actual options without accepting a new term during the correction.

Possible opening: We recorded your options inquiry as an accepted renewal; that was inaccurate and needs correction.

Success checks

- Correct the inquiry-versus-acceptance distinction.
- Keep any new lease term unagreed.
- Arrange an accurate options discussion and record review without inventing legal effects.

Add a complication: A colleague proposes treating silence after the options message as acceptance.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Agency, Representation, Compensation, and Trust

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: C - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

B: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

C: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

Check 2: B - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

B: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

C: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

Model response: Before we discuss a property, let's clarify who would represent whom and review the required disclosures and agreements. The available arrangements depend on the applicable rules and the parties' agreement.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Client Intake, Needs Analysis, and Property Search

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: B - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

B: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

C: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

Check 2: A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

B: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

C: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

Model response: What commute time and transport options would work for you? Let's also list your budget and property requirements so we can use clear, relevant criteria for the search.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Listings, Property Descriptions, Pricing, and Market Data

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: A - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

B: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

C: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

Check 2: C - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

B: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

C: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

Model response: These sales provide context, but they are not identical to the property. I'll explain the differences in size and condition and how they limit the comparison instead of presenting one certain sale price.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Showings, Open Houses, Fair Housing, and Advertising

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: C - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

B: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

C: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

Check 2: B - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

B: The requested action and information are explicit.

C: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

Model response: Please describe the rooms, features, and location facts instead. We can make the listing informative by stating what the property offers and sending the wording through our advertising review.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Offers, Counteroffers, Negotiation, and Contingencies

Editing example: If you approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

For an ordinary future condition, the "if" clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Check 1: B - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.

A: "Reviewed" places the response in the past instead of expressing the future response.

B: The "if" clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.

C: For this ordinary future condition, use present simple in the "if" clause.

Check 2: A - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

A: This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

B: It treats unreviewed work as already included.

C: It promises an outcome without examining the consequences.

Model response: The buyer prefers 30 days, but the financing timeline is not confirmed. Could we discuss the proposed timing and any relevant contingencies with the appropriate parties before making a firm commitment?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Inspections, Repairs, Disclosures, and Due Diligence

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

B: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

C: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

Check 2: C - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

B: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

C: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

Model response: The report identifies a concern but does not establish its full cause or repair cost. We can help arrange the recommended specialist review so you have better information for your decision.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Financing, Appraisal, Title, Escrow, and Closing

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: C - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

B: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

C: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

Check 2: B - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

B: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

C: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

Model response: The appraisal has been received. Title questions remain open, so I cannot say that every closing item is complete. I'll confirm the outstanding items and the next update with the responsible professionals.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Leasing, Property Management, Commercial Basics, Ethics, and Crisis Scenarios

Editing example: I'm sorry my message did not explain the timing clearly.

The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Check 1: B - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.

A: This acknowledges a missed date, not the communication problem in the question.

B: This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.

C: This acknowledges duration, but does not take responsibility for the unclear wording.

Check 2: A - The corrected date and the current confirmation status.

A: A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

B: The reader still lacks the information they need.

C: An unsupported new promise can create a second misunderstanding.

Model response: I'm sorry you have had to follow up. The issue is logged, but I do not yet have a confirmed appointment. I'll contact the responsible team and update you today, even if the timing is still pending.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Real Estate English

Professional audience: real estate agents, brokers, transaction coordinators, property managers, leasing teams, and commercial real estate staff

Scope: Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Lesson 01: Agency, Representation, Compensation, and Trust

Original fictional case: A prospective buyer asks whether an agent represents both sides. The relationship has not yet been established or documented.

Language workshop: Make a complex point clear

Communication goal: Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

Language guidance: Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): In this context, ... means / The difference is that / How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Vocabulary: Agency disclosure: Required explanation or document identifying the professional's role and who is represented. / Fiduciary duty: Duties such as loyalty, confidentiality, disclosure, obedience, reasonable care, and accounting, depending on law and role. / Buyer representation agreement: Agreement defining buyer services, term, compensation, exclusivity, and other obligations. / Designated agency: Same brokerage but different designated agents represent different clients, where permitted.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Before we discuss a property, let's clarify who would represent whom and review the required disclosures and agreements. The available arrangements depend on the applicable rules and the parties' agreement.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level